

AN ABODE ABROAD

Indians are fast emerging as big-ticket investors in residential properties overseas. Thanks to relaxed RBI norms, you can now have a home in Dubai, Malaysia, Singapore and London.



TOP OF THE LINE: The £11-million Hanover House in Wentworth, UK, and The Palm, Dubai (below)



■ By Nandini Vaish

Praveen Bhatia, a well-placed executive in a private oil services firm in Mumbai, has been to Dubai many times in the past 10 years. Not once, however, had he dreamt he would one day buy an apartment in the booming emirate. "But suddenly, the option seems irresistible," he says, explaining how he is finalising plans to pick up a studio apartment in one of the many upcoming property developments in the city.

"It makes sense to invest in Dubai and partake in its current construction boom," reasons the 43-year-old, who already owns a three-bedroom apartment in Mumbai where he resides.

Many an eyebrow may have been raised at Bhatia's decision a couple of years ago but not anymore. Like him, a growing number of Indians are looking overseas to make property investments. And though Dubai tops the list of destinations, cities like London, Singapore, New York and even parts of Australia and Canada are major attractions.